respect in the world through Soft Power and economic and social achievements, but not through the formation of a military alliance.'

Furthermore, nearly one-third of the 34 existing formats and forms of interaction under the BRICS umbrella represents a dialogue between numerous states of civil society, including the informal public. These include economic, commercial, social, and scientific research groups, organizations like the Civic Forum, the BRICS Trade Union Forum, the Youth Forum, the Exchange Alliance, the Meeting of Twin Towns and Municipalities, the Urbanization Forum, and also the meeting of the Cooperative Associations of the BRICS countries, as well as the Seminar on Population Studies (Budaev 2015). The impressive part about the BRICS group is that official diplomacy and intensive cooperation via multiple government agencies and organizations has been happening by non-traditional 'Soft Power' diplomacy methods only (ibid.).

The importance of the Soft Power phenomenon in BRICS started from its very inception itself. It could be seen with the establishment of the BRICS Think Tank Council at the 2011 New Delhi BRICS summit. All five members signed the BRICS Academic Forum at the 2013 Durban Summit. It was intended for collaboration with diverse research organizations to research BRICS (Budaev 2015). Another vital aspect of the BRICS soft power asset is that BRICS strives to promote new rules and civilized standards of global governance. BRICS is a system that makes it possible to communicate between various civilizations, be it Indian, Chinese, Eurasian/Russian, African, or Latin American. Thus, this framework for inter-civilizational dialogue can promote the mutual advancement of several cultures and thwart a Westernized cultural expansion and its comprehensive policies by a few 'golden billion' countries (Titarenko and Petrovsky 2015). The question that then arises is: what makes BRICS unique, and what makes it unique given the number of groups in the international system?

Reasons for the Emergence of BRICS as a Decisive Group

The inter-continental representation of Latin America, Africa, Asia, and Eurasia gives the BRICS group a stellar identity in the history of international relations. China and Russia's inclusion in the group, and their membership in the UNSC, give more advantage for influence in its present and future world politics. Renowned scholar Andrew Hurrell (2006) provides a few reasons for the BRICS collective. These are listed below.

- BRICS countries have an equally high level of similar political, economic, and military power resources. They have some degree of cohesion regionally and